

3.3.5 The screen blanks after it is idle for some time even without the screensaver

Cause: This could be due to the Power Management settings in either Windows or the BIOS. The settings control when the monitor should blank out after a period of inactivity.

Solution: Disable Power Management (ACPI) in the BIOS. If required, disable it in Windows as well. (Right-click on the Desktop, select Properties, and click the Power Management button on the Screen Saver tab).

3.3.6 A 'Not Enough Video Memory' error message comes up

Cause: This message would appear when you have run out of both RAM and virtual memory.

Solution: Increase the virtual memory of your system. Virtual memory should be at least 1.5 times your physical RAM. In Windows XP, right-click My Computer and select Properties. Click the Advanced tab, and click Settings under Performance. Select the Advanced tab. Under Virtual Memory, click Change. Select Custom, and set Initial equal to the amount of RAM you have and Maximum to 1.5 times the RAM you have.

3.3.7 The PC works fine for a few hours and then freezes

Cause: This symptom is typical of overheating. Overheating processors are a major source of PC freezes and crashes. Other than the main processor, the graphics processor can also overheat and bring the entire PC to a grinding halt. Like the CPU, the graphics processor has its own heat sink and fan. An overheating graphics processor would point to some problem with the cooling system.

Solution: Troubleshooting this is similar to troubleshooting an overheating CPU. However, you should eliminate all the other heat generating culprits first: check the power supply, the CPU heat sink, and fan. Once you have eliminated these possibilities, turn your attention to the graphics processor: check the heat sink and fan, it may be that the fan is not working or the heat sink is not fitted snugly on the graphics processor. Check the power connections for the fan and reseat the heat sink to fit it tightly with the processor. Use thermal paste if necessary.